

IONUȚ FRANCISC

Security & Privacy (GRC) Consultant | Secure-by-Design | Incident Governance | PKI / HSM

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PROFILE

- Security, Privacy, and GRC professional with 10+ years across risk assessments, privacy-by-design, secure-by-design reviews, audit readiness, incident governance, and control evidence.
- CSIRT-facing BISO delegate experience coordinating intake, stakeholders, remediation actions, closure criteria, and lessons learned.
- Hands-on exposure to PKI, certificate lifecycle management, key exchanges, and Gemalto Cloud HSM in a regulated banking and blockchain context.
- Founder and systems builder combining security thinking with web products, automation, and AI-assisted delivery for real businesses.

CORE EXPERTISE

Security & assurance: risk assessments, control interpretation, control-to-evidence mapping, ITGC concepts, audit readiness, remediation follow-up.

Privacy & governance: DPIA / PIA support, privacy-by-design, GDPR awareness, data classification, incident governance.

Technical delivery: PKI, certificates, HSM, Zero Trust principles, React, Next.js, TypeScript, Netlify, WordPress, automation, AI-assisted development.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant & Founder

Security, privacy, web products, automation, and founder-led delivery | Current

- Review and build privacy-aware websites, digital products, automation flows, and practical systems for founders and small teams.
- Operate and develop business initiatives including FiraWeb and ElectroVerde, connecting technical delivery with real operational needs.

Security & Privacy by Design Consultant - IBM Consulting

Architecture & Assurance | Jul 2024 - Oct 2025

- Performed secure-by-design and privacy-by-design reviews for new tools and applications, clarifying requirements, controls, evidence, findings, owners, and timelines.
- Aligned risk outputs with architecture and delivery constraints and supported decision-ready stakeholder communication.

CSIRT Consulting - BISO Delegate - IBM Consulting

Incident governance | Jun 2020 - Jul 2024

- Coordinated incident intake, action tracking, stakeholder alignment, documentation traceability, closure criteria, and post-incident review activities.
- Translated findings into remediation tasks and clear follow-up across security and technology teams.

Security & Privacy Consultant - IBM we.trade

Regulated banking / blockchain platform | Sep 2018 - Sep 2020

- Supported security and privacy compliance, security reviews, remediation recommendations, PKI requirements, certificate issuance and QA, and audit procedures.
- Supported Gemalto Cloud HSM key exchanges, troubleshooting, upgrades, and documentation.

Security Risk Analyst / Advisor / Coordinator - IBM GBS DS&P

Multiple international assignments | Jun 2015 - Jun 2018

- Delivered security risk assessments and control reviews across UK&I, CEE, and Italy portfolios and guided teams on evidence quality.
- Coordinated assessment operations and performed AUP-style ITGC internal testing in SAP environments.

Customs Agent - DHL, Henri Coanda Airport

Customs operations | Two years before IBM

- Worked with regulated documentation, operational deadlines, and accuracy-sensitive customs processes at Bucharest Otopeni Airport.

Founder / Network Operator - Neighborhood Mini-ISP

Entrepreneurial project during university

- Built and operated a local network serving approximately 200-300 customers, covering infrastructure, troubleshooting, support, and daily operations.

EDUCATION

- Master's degree, Economic IT - Romanian-American University, Bucharest.
- Bachelor's degree, Computer Science for Business Management / General Economy - Romanian-American University, Bucharest.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900).
- Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA) & IBM Technology (2025).
- IBM Security Zero Trust Principles (2025).
- Privacy Foundations (2021).
- Public credential trail: credly.com/users/ionut-iulian-francisc.

LANGUAGES

Romanian - native | English - fluent | Italian - good